

Module 10: Monitor, Control, and Completing the Project

Verifying and Issuing a Status Report

1. Verification of Implementation

- a. Ensure reported progress is actually implemented and working.
- b. Use Agile practices or develop implementation checklists for quality control.

2. Monitoring and Adjustments

- a. Check if designed solutions are correctly implemented or need adjustments.
- b. Monitor resistance and negotiate alternatives if needed.

3. Project Status Report

- a. A project status report compiles project progress and triggers decisions or actions.
- b. Use written reports (physical or digital) for record-keeping, accountability, and distributing performance information.

4. Content of Status Reports

- a. Compare planned activities with actual progress and identify deviations.
- b. Check if the project is on track in terms of costs, time, and resources.
- c. Highlight changes in project context (e.g., team member exits, new requirements from management).

5. Change Requests

- a. Issue change requests when necessary (e.g., shortening project duration due to external demands).

6. Ensuring Deliverables

- b. Verify on-site that deliverables meet expectations and implementation is effective.

7. Team Participation

- c. Ensure the right people are involved in the management system, integrating it into the organization's day-to-day operations.

Communication about the Project Status

1. Send Status Report in Advance

- d. Share the project status report before monitor and control meetings.
- e. This gives team members time to read, reflect, and prepare, ensuring more productive meetings.

2. Monitor and Control Meetings

- a. These meetings assess project status, share updates, and make decisions or changes as needed.

3. Invitation to Stakeholders

- b. Send meeting invitations with the status report and agenda to relevant stakeholders identified during project planning.
- 4. Meeting Agenda
 - c. Date, Place, Start Time: Ensure punctuality by providing clear meeting details.
 - d. End Time: Reassure participants the meeting will end on time.
 - e. Overall Purpose: Clearly state the meeting's goal and required decisions.
 - f. Content, Purpose, Responsible People, Time Allotted: Outline what will be discussed, by whom, and for how long.
 - g. Links: Provide access to relevant information participants need to prepare.

Monitor and Control Meetings

- 1. Purpose of Meetings
 - a. Keep projects on track, manage resources, avoid conflicts, and align the team.
 - b. Empower team members with information and decisions.
- 2. Frequency of Meetings
 - a. Connect meeting frequency to important project milestones.
 - b. Avoid excessive frequency to prevent wasted time and micromanagement.
 - c. Insufficient monitoring risks delayed decisions.
- 3. Focus of Meetings
 - a. Avoid presentations and individual analyses; focus on collaborative actions.
 - b. Evaluate past performance and progress against the project plan.
 - c. Discuss and resolve concerns, opportunities, and conflicts.
- 4. Status Updates
 - a. Team members report the status of their assignments and any issues.
 - b. Maintain an issues list for unresolved concerns.
- 5. Conflict Management
 - a. Monitor and resolve conflicts over resources and opinions.
 - b. Escalate unresolved conflicts to the project sponsor.
- 6. Change Requests
 - a. Assess if changes to the project plan, resources, or responsibilities are needed.
 - b. Identify and manage new risks.
- 7. Meeting Outcomes
 - a. Generate a meeting record with decisions and conclusions.
 - b. Update the project plan and validate change requests.
 - c. Clearly communicate decisions and responsibilities to all team members.
- 8. Documentation

- a. Keep files of meeting records and updated documents, distributing them to all participants.
- 9. Completion of Implementation Phase
 - b. Conclude with two key activities:
 - c. Conduct an internal audit.
 - d. Conduct a management review by top management.

Internal Audit

- 1. Purpose of Internal Audit
 - a. Provides an independent assessment of how well the management system meets standards and requirements.
 - b. Evaluates conformity with internal rules and standards essential for certification.
- 2. Mandatory Requirement
 - a. Conducting internal audits is necessary for organizations seeking certification.
- 3. Role of Project Manager
 - b. Ensure an internal audit is conducted to assess the implementation of the management system.
 - c. Collaborate with the project sponsor or internal leader, using either internal or external auditors.
- 4. Audit Outcomes
 - a. Internal audit reports address key questions:
 - b. Are we doing it right?
 - c. Compliance with existing policies and procedures.
 - d. Are we doing the right thing?
 - e. Achievement of intended outcomes through compliance.
 - f. What adjustments are necessary?
 - g. Identify areas for simplification without compromising results.
- 5. Focus of Internal Audit
 - a. Emphasizes prevention, discipline, learning from mistakes, and continuous improvement.
 - b. Avoids blame, judgment, and punishment.

Management Review Purpose

- 1. Mandatory Requirement
 - a. Management Review is essential before certification and helps evaluate the management system's utility and appropriateness.
- 2. Objective Evaluation

- b. Assess if improvements are needed and determine desired outcomes for future performance.
- 3. Continuous Improvement
 - c. The primary purpose of the management review is to foster continual improvement of the management system, enhancing overall performance.
- 4. Janus Moment
 - d. A management review serves as a moment to:
 - e. Look back: Evaluate the previous management cycle.
 - f. Look ahead: Make decisions for the upcoming cycle.
 - g. Identify strengths to leverage and weaknesses to address.
- 5. Review Frequency
 - a. Conduct management reviews regularly (weekly or monthly).
 - b. Consider two types of reviews:
 - c. Extraordinary Management Review:
 - d. Top management assesses overall performance and sets rules for the next cycle.
 - e. Design, strategy, and objectives can be re-evaluated.
 - f. Ordinary Management Review:
 - g. Focus on reviewing performance against targets without questioning strategic orientation.
 - h. Identify necessary improvements.
- 6. Honesty in Evaluation
 - a. Embrace transparency; negative evaluations indicate areas for improvement, not failure.
 - b. Hiding problems can lead to external non-conformities during audits.
- 7. Common Myths
 - a. One Annual Review: Instead, hold multiple monthly reviews for ongoing assessment.
 - b. All Requirements in One Meeting: Allow for in-depth discussions over several meetings for effectiveness.
 - c. Follow ISO Rigidly: Use ISO standards as guidelines, not strict rules, to ensure comprehensive reviews.

Management Review Preparation and Execution

- 1. No Universal Approach
 - a. Tailor the management review process to fit your organization, ensuring it motivates participation and delivers results.
- 2. Participants
 - b. Involve a mix of top management and other managers, acknowledging their experience with numerous meetings. Emphasize the importance of this meeting to avoid it being perceived as just another meeting.

3. Preparation Steps
 - c. Send Agenda: Communicate the meeting's purpose, content, participants, and required inputs.
 - d. Review Standards: Use the management system standard as a guideline to outline agenda items.
 - e. Assign Responsibilities: Designate individuals to prepare summaries of performance on specific items (e.g., management system objectives, internal audit conclusions).
4. Performance Assessment
 - a. Evaluate internal issues such as:
 - b. Achievement of management system objectives.
 - c. Effectiveness of action plans.
 - d. Internal audit findings.
 - e. Include external opportunities and threats relevant to the organization's context.
5. Top Management Preparation
 - a. Prepare the top manager to lead the meeting, demonstrating leadership and commitment to the management system.
6. Focus on Conclusions and Decisions
 - a. Stress that the meeting is not for data presentation but for collaborative decision-making.
 - b. Discuss areas for improvement in the management system, strategic orientation, and future challenges.
7. Outputs of the Meeting
 - a. Conclude with:
 - b. Assessment of management system effectiveness and suitability.
 - c. Decisions on policies, objectives, necessary improvements, and required resources.
 - d. Evaluate the completion of the implementation project and decide on its acceptance and closure.

Acceptance and Implementation Closure

1. Purpose of Closure
 - a. Achieve an orderly end to the implementation project after delivering services as per the agreement.
2. Post-Management Review Actions
 - b. After the management review and addressing all internal audit non-conformities, confirm project completion and initiate closure procedures.
3. Closure Procedures
 - c. Project Sponsor Agreement: Ensure the project sponsor agrees that all deliverables have been met.

- d. Transfer Responsibilities: Shift project management responsibilities to permanent roles within the organization.
 - e. Archiving Records: Safely archive sensitive project records.
 - f. Closure Statement: Issue a closure statement to release all parties from their obligations under the agreement.
4. Feedback and Improvement
- a. Gather feedback to learn from the project:
 - b. Conduct a final meeting with the project team.
 - c. Hold individual interviews to discuss project implementation and results.
 - d. Use feedback to identify areas for future improvements.